

STAGE FOURTEEN • PROJECT MANAGEMENT

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 30 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Fourteen • Project Management

OVERVIEW

Stage Fourteen's thirty FIRSTS split across three sessions, matching the Manual's existing structure: Project Planning Foundations, Managing Execution, and Modern Methodologies & Closing Out. Each session pairs short facilitator framing with individual planning work, ideally applied to one real, consistent project that a participant carries across all three sessions.

This stage benefits enormously from participants having one real, ongoing project (school, work, or personal) to apply every FIRST to consistently, rather than a different hypothetical example each time. Encourage this explicitly during Session 1's opening.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Project Planning Foundations — R1-R10	~120 min
Session 2	Managing Execution — R11-R20	~115 min
Session 3	Modern Methodologies & Closing Out — R21-R30	~110 min

SESSION 1

Project Planning Foundations

Covers FIRSTS R1-R10: Project Management Awareness, Project Initiation, Project Scope Defined, Project Requirements Gathered, Project Deliverables Defined, Project Timeline Created, Project Work Breakdown, Project Resource Plan, Project Risk Register, Project Dependency Map.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one real project, current, upcoming, or recently completed, that they can reference and build on throughout all three sessions of this stage.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: project management is a discipline you can learn, not just a job title	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST R1 — Project Management Awareness: map a past project against the lifecycle	Solo
0:25–0:40	FIRST R2 — Project Initiation: draft a real initiation document	Solo
0:40–0:55	FIRST R3 — Project Scope Defined: in-scope/out-of-scope list	Solo
0:55–1:10	FIRST R4 — Project Requirements Gathered	Solo
1:10–1:15	Short break	—

1:15-1:30	FIRST R5 — Project Deliverables Defined: map requirements to deliverables	Solo
1:30-1:45	FIRST R6 — Project Timeline Created	Solo
1:45-2:00	FIRST R7 — Project Work Breakdown	Solo
2:00-2:20	FIRSTS R8-R9 — Resource Plan + Risk Register	Solo
2:20-2:35	FIRST R10 — Project Dependency Map + session close	Solo, then full-group share of one bottleneck found

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session is the longest and most planning-dense in the stage. If running short on time, FIRSTS R8 and R9 can compress into one combined block since both are relatively quick, structured exercises.
- Push consistently for participants to use the same real project across every FIRST this session — switching examples between exercises loses the compounding value of building one coherent project plan.

SESSION 2

Managing Execution

Covers FIRSTS R11–R20: Project Stakeholder Map, Project Communication Plan, Project Status Report, Project Milestone Achieved, Project Change Request, Project Issue Log, Project Risk Mitigation, Project Budget Created, Project Schedule Updated, Project Management Tool Used.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring their Session 1 planning documents (or notes) — this session builds directly on the project defined last time.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + bridge: planning is done, now let's manage the real, moving parts of execution	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST R11 — Project Stakeholder Map	Solo
0:25–0:40	FIRST R12 — Project Communication Plan	Solo
0:40–0:55	FIRST R13 — Project Status Report: build a template	Solo
0:55–1:10	FIRST R14 — Project Milestone Achieved: define real criteria	Solo
1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:35	FIRSTS R15–R16 — Change Request + Issue Log	Solo
1:35–1:50	FIRST R17 — Project Risk Mitigation: act on a real risk from R9	Solo
1:50–2:10	FIRST R18 — Project Budget Created	Solo
2:10–2:25	FIRSTS R19–R20 — Schedule Updated + Tool Used + close	Solo, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST R17 explicitly requires acting on a risk identified back in R9 — if a participant's R9 register is thin, help them identify a genuine risk now rather than skipping this FIRST.
- FIRST R20 (tool consolidation) works well as a live, hands-on close if participants have laptop access — have them actually enter their project into a tool during the session rather than just discussing it.

SESSION 3

Modern Methodologies & Closing Out

Covers FIRSTS R21–R30: Agile Project Experience, Scrum Experience, Kanban Workflow, Project Progress Review, Project Escalation, Project Recovery Plan, Project Handoff, Project Closure, Project Lessons Learned, End-to-End Project Managed.

PRE-WORK

- No specific preparation required. This session shifts from the participant's own project plan toward modern methodologies and formal closure practices; be ready to discuss the participant's real project's current state.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today covers how modern teams actually work, plus how every project should properly end	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST R21 — Agile Project Experience: reflect on a real adaptive moment	Solo
0:25–0:40	FIRST R22 — Scrum Experience: ceremony purposes	Solo
0:40–0:55	FIRST R23 — Kanban Workflow: set up a real board	Solo, hands-on if tools available
0:55–1:10	FIRST R24 — Project Progress Review: honest comparison	Solo
1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:30	FIRST R25 — Project Escalation	Solo
1:30–1:45	FIRST R26 — Project Recovery Plan	Solo
1:45–2:00	FIRST R27 — Project Handoff: draft a real package	Solo
2:00–2:15	FIRSTS R28–R29 — Project Closure + Lessons Learned	Solo
2:15–2:30	FIRST R30 — End-to-End Project Managed + full-stage close	Solo, then full-group commitment share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRSTS R21–R23 are conceptually distinct from the rest of this session; if a participant has no direct Agile/Scrum/Kanban experience yet, treat these as awareness-building rather than requiring genuine personal application.
- FIRST R30 is the capstone of the entire stage — give it genuine room, and have each participant name one specific upcoming project they'll manage end-to-end using what they've built across all three sessions.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Fifteen (Business & Organizational Acumen), which builds directly on the organizational awareness this stage has been developing.